

Official Maintenance of ICH Impurity Guidelines

How Q3C, Q3D, and M7 Guidelines Are
Updated & Kept Current

DEPARTMENT: PHARMACEUTICAL ANALYSIS / REGULATORY AFFAIRS

SCOPE OF THE MAINTENANCE PROCEDURE

This official procedure explains how ICH revises existing guidelines as new materials are accepted or new safety data becomes available.



Q3C

Residual Solvents Control &
PDE Limits



Q3D

Elemental Impurities (Metals)
Safety Limits



M7 Addendum

DNA Reactive (Mutagenic)
Impurities assessment

TYPES OF REVISIONS ALLOWED

Guideline	Specific Allowed Changes
Q3C (Solvents)	Adding PDE limits for new solvents or revising existing PDEs based on new toxicological data.
Q3D (Metals)	Adding PDEs for new elements, administration routes, or revising metal limits as toxicity findings evolve.
M7 (Mutagenic)	Adding AI or PDE limits for new mutagenic impurities or updating existing limits with new data.

SUBMITTING A REVISION PROPOSAL

Who and How?

-  **The Channels:** Proposals are sent to the ICH Secretariat.
-  **Eligibility:** Any ICH Member, Observer, or Stakeholder.
-  **Requirement:** Proposals must be backed by high-quality info.



STANDARDS FOR ACCEPTABLE SAFETY DATA

ICH requires **high-quality toxicological proof**.

Accepted study types include:



Repeat-dose toxicity studies



Reproductive toxicity studies



Genotoxicity & Carcinogenicity (M7 Focus)

PROHIBITED DATA

Single-dose toxicity data alone cannot be used to calculate or change a PDE or AI.

ICH will not initiate a change without strong, reproducible proof.

EXPERT WORKING GROUP (EWG)



FINAL MINUTES

Management Committee Meeting in Singapore
16, 17 and 19 November 2025

FINAL MINUTES

ICH ASSEMBLY SINGAPORE MEETING
18-19 NOVEMBER 2025

A dedicated Expert Working Group (EWG) evaluates every proposal received.



Core Membership: Generally consistent, following ICH SOPs.

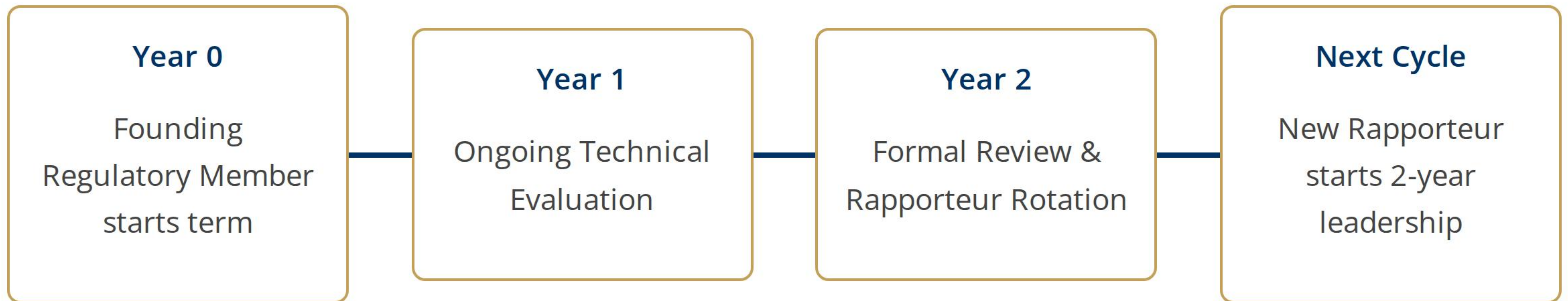


Observer Input: Can nominate experts to join the EWG.



Leadership: Led by a Rapporteur from a Founding Member.

LEADERSHIP ROTATION & REVIEW TIMELINE



Proposals are formally evaluated once every 2 years after rotation.

STRICT FILTERING RULES



Significant Impact

Revisions only considered if new data causes **major changes** in limits or proves old data invalid.



No Minor Changes

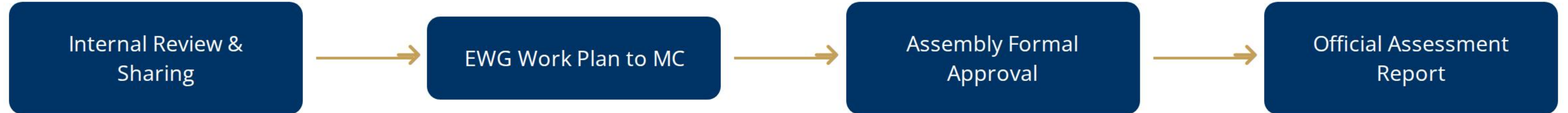
The group does not waste resources on insignificant or small PDE tweaks.



Digital First

Primarily uses email, document sharing, and video calls to save time and travel.

STEP-BY-STEP APPROVAL WORKFLOW



The Final Document: The Rapporteur writes an official assessment report to accept, modify, or reject the change based on EWG consensus.

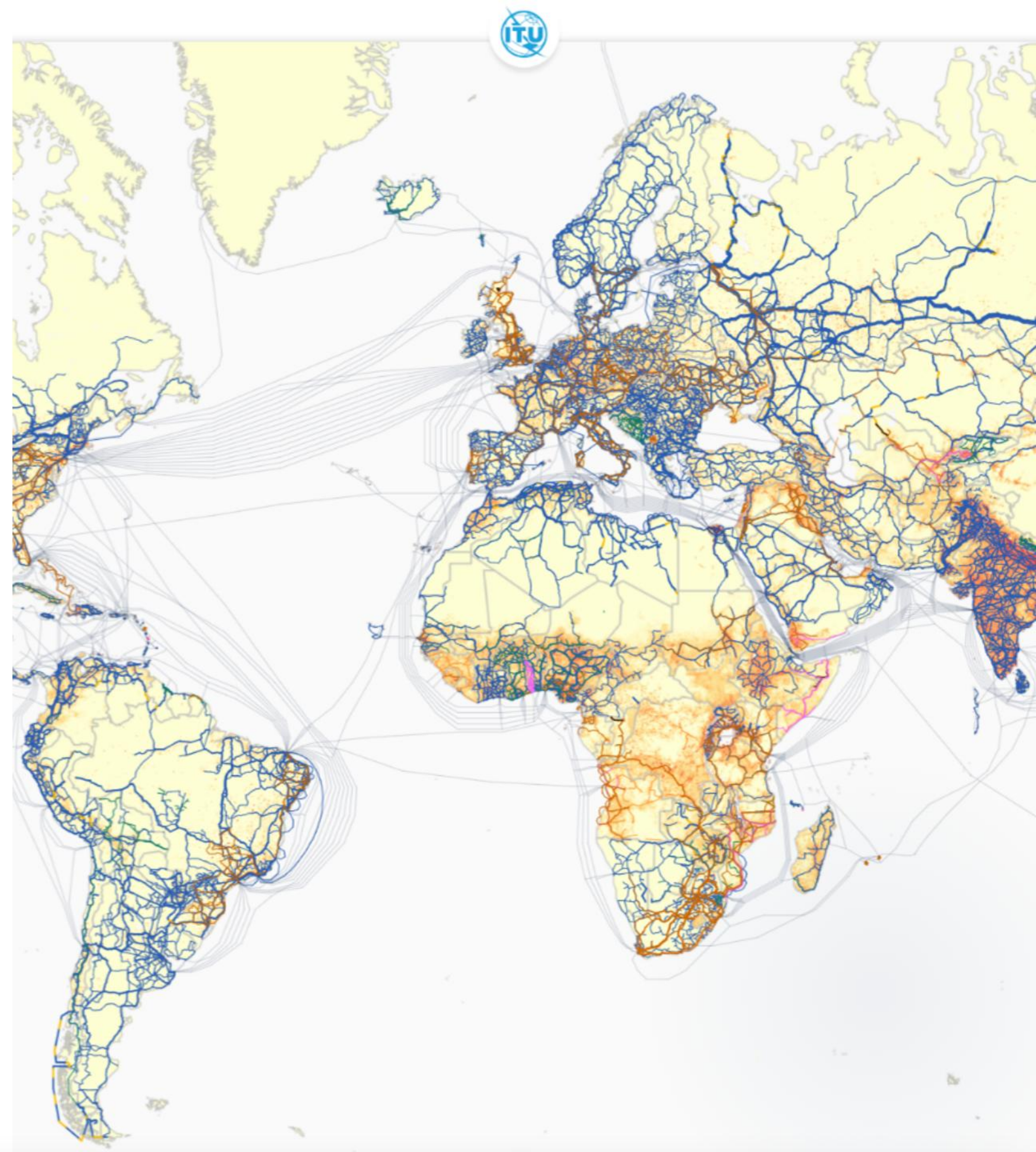
PUBLIC REVIEW & TRANSPARENCY

Step 3 of ICH Process

Once the Assembly approves, the recommendation is published in each global region for public comment.

Pharmacopoeias: Proposals are shared with international pharmacopoeias simultaneously.

**To prevent confusion, only exact changes to core guidelines or new addendums are listed.*



FINALIZING AND ADOPTING



AUTHORIZED DEALER CERTIFICATE

This certificate confirms that **[Dealer Name]** has met the requirements and is authorized to act as an Official Dealer for

[Brand Name]

The authorization includes product distribution, marketing, and support services in **[Region]**.

Certificate ID: [###-###-###]

Validity: [Start Date] - [End Date]

[Your Name]
[Your Position]



Verify Credential ID:



Feedback: EWG gathers via remote meetings to finalize based on comments.



Adoption: Recommendation sent to Assembly for official adoption.



Launch: Implementation follows local regional practices and pharmacopoeia publication.

RAPID INFORMATION DISSEMINATION

How Industry is Notified

When a new PDE or AI limit is approved, the ICH Management Committee (MC) ensures rapid transmission through:



ICH Official Website
Immediate Publication



Pharmacopoeias
Online Forums & Sites



Member Sites
Mandatory Feature Details

IMAGE SOURCES



<https://jamiahamdardonline.in/assets/img/blog/drug-regulatory-affairs-course-benefits.png>

Source: jamiahamdardonline.in



https://admin.ich.org/sites/default/files/2026-01/Final%20minutes%20ICH51%20Singapore_SCREENSHOT.jpg

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